

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Media and Entertainment English



Teacher's guide

Teach practical workplace communication with specific cases, clear language targets, and a repeatable feedback process.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For producers, production managers, creative executives, rights coordinators, distribution teams, talent managers, marketing staff, and media operations professionals.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Creative Briefs and Development Notes

Clarify missing information before responding.

02 Production Planning and Budget

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

03 Rights, Clearances, and Licensing

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

04 Talent, Contracts, and Approvals

Clarify missing information before responding.

05 Distribution and Windowing

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

06 Audience Metrics and Performance

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

07 Sponsorship, Brand Safety, and Integration

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

08 Crisis Response and Public Statements

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop, or use the prompts at the end of this guide.

A 60-minute lesson that works

Prepare the case and the learner pages. Keep the model response hidden until learners have attempted their own. Choose two field terms that are important to understanding the case.

0-5 minutes | Activate experience

Ask learners to name a comparable situation without sharing confidential details. Introduce the communication goal.

5-12 minutes | Read and sort facts

Read the case. Learners identify confirmed facts, unknowns, the audience, and the immediate communication need.

12-22 minutes | Notice and practice language

Explain the workshop pattern. Work through the vocabulary and editing example, then discuss both language checks and the reasons behind the choices.

22-35 minutes | 05 • Conversations

Read one ten-turn conversation aloud, notice a useful expression, then compare the other two. Identify each speaker's purpose and how the exchange ends.

35-47 minutes | 06 • Say it

Rehearse both speaking scenarios from the workbook. Give two minutes of preparation, switch roles, and use the success checks. Add the complication only after a successful first round.

47-55 minutes | Compare and revise

Reveal the model. Discuss alternative acceptable wording. Give one meaning correction and one language correction, then repeat.

55-60 minutes | Retrieve and transfer

Close the materials. Learners recall two expressions and identify one communication habit to use in another situation.

Adapt the session

For 45 minutes, study one complete conversation and rehearse one scenario; assign the others for oral follow-up. For 90 minutes, rehearse all three conversations and give both scenarios a second round. More time should produce more meaningful practice, not longer explanations.

LESSON 01 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Creative Briefs and Development Notes

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A client asks for a video to feel "premium and energetic." The team has no examples, audience definition, or delivery requirements.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: creative brief, tone, brand fit, deliverable.

Model response

Could you share a reference and explain which qualities you want to capture? Let's also confirm the audience and deliverables so the creative direction can be discussed concretely.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. A - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 • Conversations

1. What does premium sound like? - The producer clarifies the lesson's incomplete video brief with the client creative lead; audience and delivery requirements remain unknown.
2. A trailer or a complete story? - Separate fictional case: a museum commissions a thirty-second exhibit trailer for its lobby screen, without specifying whether it should include narration.

3. Two meanings of playful - Separate fictional case: a podcast producer and a commissioning editor discuss a gardening series for first-time apartment gardeners; the brief requests a playful tone.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Which version belongs on the screen?

In a fictional cinema campaign, the client requests one poster animation for both a silent foyer screen and an online placement with sound. Only the foyer dimensions are supplied. Hold a clarification call and agree what must be confirmed before production.

Role A: You are the motion producer. Clarify whether one deliverable or two adapted versions are expected.

Role B: You are the campaign coordinator. You know the foyer is silent but must obtain the online specifications.

Possible opening: Before we estimate the animation, could you clarify whether you need separate versions for the two placements?

Success checks

- Clarify the deliverables and sound requirements separately.
- Keep the online specifications explicitly unresolved.
- Agree who will obtain the missing specifications before production is scheduled.

Add a complication: The client calls the online version a simple resize, although its dimensions and duration remain unknown.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 02 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Production Planning and Budget

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

CASE

A production schedule adds a location change, but transport time and the budget have not been revised.

Teach this move

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Vocabulary to check: production budget, call sheet, location, permit.

Model response

The location change adds work that is not reflected in the current schedule or budget. I'll identify the transport and setup implications for review before we confirm the revised plan.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Second-round challenge

The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Language-check answers

1. C - The team has completed the review. 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.
2. B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it. This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

05 · Conversations

1. The move is not yet scheduled - A production manager updates a producer on the lesson's added location change; transport time and the production budget are still unrevised.
2. Rain cover remains an option - Separate fictional case: a commercial shoot has a confirmed outdoor booking; an indoor rain-cover quote is available but has not been accepted.

3. The revised call sheet has not reached everyone - Separate fictional case: a studio shoot's revised call sheet changes the makeup call to seven; camera crew receipts are confirmed, but makeup receipt is not.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A vehicle booking with no driver confirmation

In a fictional documentary shoot, a vehicle reservation is confirmed for Tuesday, but the supplier has not confirmed a driver. Equipment collection depends on that vehicle. Give a production status update and agree the next check.

Role A: You are the transport coordinator. Explain the confirmed reservation and the outstanding driver assignment.

Role B: You are the production manager. Ask what this means for equipment collection and the call sheet.

Possible opening: The vehicle is reserved for Tuesday, but we still need confirmation of the driver.

Success checks

- Distinguish a vehicle reservation from a confirmed transport arrangement.
- Explain the dependency without inventing a delay.
- Agree who will contact the supplier and update production.

Add a complication: A colleague wants the call sheet to describe transport as fully confirmed.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 03 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Rights, Clearances, and Licensing

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

CASE

A draft video includes music with unclear licensing documentation. The planned channels and territories are known.

Teach this move

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Vocabulary to check: rights, clearance, license, territory.

Model response

Could the rights team confirm that the license covers the planned channels and territories? I'll provide the intended use and asset details so the clearance question can be reviewed before publication.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Second-round challenge

The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Language-check answers

1. B - Send it no later than Thursday. 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.
2. A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review? The requested action and information are explicit.

05 · Conversations

1. Find the music license before release - The lesson's draft video uses music with unclear licensing documentation; the planned channels and territories are already recorded.
2. An archive clip needs a new use review - Separate fictional case: a studio holds documentation for an archive clip in an internal training film and now proposes a public festival trailer.

3. A still image without a source trail - Separate fictional case: a magazine's digital teaser includes a historical photograph copied from a research deck; the original source and permission status are unknown.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A licensed excerpt in a longer cut

A fictional educational film has a documented license for a twenty-second excerpt. A proposed new cut uses thirty seconds. The effect of that change has not been reviewed. Discuss the request for rights review, not the legal answer.

Role A: You are the editor. Supply the old and proposed durations and request a review before picture lock.

Role B: You are the clearance producer. Ask for the license and both timecoded excerpts, and discuss when you can respond.

Possible opening: Could you review whether our proposed thirty-second excerpt is covered before we lock this new cut?

Success checks

- State both durations without assuming permission.
- Request the license and timecoded material for a defined review.
- Agree a status check without promising an external clearance date.

Add a complication: The director says ten extra seconds cannot matter and asks you to skip the review.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 04 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Talent, Contracts, and Approvals

Clarify missing information before responding.

CASE

A talent agreement includes an approval step, but the production calendar does not show who submits material or when.

Teach this move

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Vocabulary to check: talent agreement, approval right, likeness, release.

Model response

Who submits the material for approval, what is being reviewed, and what timing does the agreement specify? Let's put those responsibilities into the production schedule.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Second-round challenge

The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Language-check answers

1. A - Could you confirm when the review starts? The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".
2. C - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review? This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

05 • Conversations

1. Who sends the talent approval package? - The lesson's talent agreement includes an approval step, but the calendar omits the submission owner and timing.
2. Which photograph did the agent approve? - Separate fictional case: an agent's email approves portrait file P4; a publicity folder contains P4 and a differently cropped file P4-square.
3. A signed release is not a recorded review - Separate fictional case: a training-video project has a signed contributor release and a project checklist with an unfilled interview-review item; the item's purpose is unclear.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Audio approval with no named version

A fictional audiobook project's approval message says the sample is fine. Two samples were sent: a narration-only file and a version with music. No filename is named in the reply. Clarify which version was approved before giving the studio instructions.

Role A: You are the studio coordinator. Identify the ambiguity and ask for version-specific confirmation.

Role B: You are the talent liaison. You have the reply but no further information about its scope.

Possible opening: Could you confirm whether the approval refers to the narration-only sample or the version with music?

Success checks

- Name the two versions distinctly.
- Avoid treating the reply as approval of both versions.
- Agree who will obtain and relay the specific confirmation.

Add a complication: The studio wants to book final mixing based on the ambiguous reply.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 05 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Distribution and Windowing

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

CASE

Two distribution proposals offer different exclusivity periods and territories. A summary compares only the fee.

Teach this move

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Vocabulary to check: windowing, exclusivity, platform, rights window.

Model response

The fee is only one difference. We should compare the rights window, territory, exclusivity, and other terms before describing one proposal as more valuable.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. 'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Second-round challenge

Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Language-check answers

1. C - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less. 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.
2. B - An increase of one percentage point. Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

05 • Conversations

1. Compare what the fee buys - The lesson's distribution proposals differ in exclusivity and territory, but their summary shows only fees; exact terms are not supplied here.
2. A short exclusive window or a longer nonexclusive run - Separate fictional case: a short film receives two offers for the same territory: six months exclusive at 8,000 units or twelve months nonexclusive at 6,000 units; other terms remain unreviewed.

3. Download access versus festival access - Separate fictional case: a documentary team compares two proposed first releases: a paid download platform with no minimum guarantee and a festival package with a fixed screening fee; both have unconfirmed later-window restrictions.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | One territory or three?

For a fictional series, offer A pays 12,000 units for one territory and offer B pays 18,000 for three territories. Both run for one year and are nonexclusive. Translation costs and delivery requirements are unknown. Compare the offers without assuming identical net income.

Role A: You are the producer. Ask what the wider territory offer requires and explain your preferred comparison criteria.

Role B: You are the distribution manager. State known terms and identify the missing costs and deliverables.

Possible opening: Both offers run for one year, but the higher fee covers three territories rather than one.

Success checks

- Compare duration, scope, and fees on a consistent basis.
- Explain why territory counts alone do not establish value.
- Identify delivery and translation questions before recommending an offer.

Add a complication: A colleague divides each fee by territory and declares the lower total offer automatically superior.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 06 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Audience Metrics and Performance

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

A campaign video reaches more viewers but has a lower completion rate. A report labels it an unqualified success.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: reach, completion rate, retention, audience segment.

Model response

Reach increased, while completion rate declined. I'll relate each measure to the campaign objective and avoid treating one headline number as the full performance story.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. B - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. A - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 · Conversations

1. Wider reach, weaker completion - An audience analyst challenges the lesson's unqualified success claim: campaign reach increased while completion rate declined.
2. The cliff at the opening titles - Separate fictional case: a streaming episode's retention chart drops at the opening-title sequence; no comparison with earlier episodes or device types has been made.

3. A higher percentage from a smaller group - Separate fictional case: two teaser tests use different invited audiences; A has 80 completions from 100 starts and B has 45 from 50 starts.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | Shares without sentiment

A fictional interview clip receives twice as many shares as the previous clip over the same seven-day period. Comments have not been reviewed, and the audience sizes differ. Discuss what the producer can responsibly say about audience response.

Role A: You are the audience analyst. Separate the share count from sentiment and comparable engagement rates.

Role B: You are the executive producer. Challenge whether the increase proves viewers liked the interview.

Possible opening: Shares increased, but we haven't established whether people are sharing the clip positively or critically.

Success checks

- State the observed share increase and measurement period.
- Keep sentiment and audience-adjusted comparisons unresolved.
- Agree which evidence to review before using a preference claim.

Add a complication: The promotional team wants to call it the audience's favorite interview.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 07 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Sponsorship, Brand Safety, and Integration

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

CASE

A sponsor requests an additional product mention after the integration plan has been agreed.

Teach this move

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

Vocabulary to check: brand safety, product placement, deliverable, makegood.

Model response

We can review the request against the agreed deliverables and editorial requirements. Could we clarify the exact change and its implications before confirming that it is included?

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. For an ordinary future condition, the "if" clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Second-round challenge

The preferred option is unavailable. Offer an alternative and clearly state any approval still needed.

Language-check answers

1. A - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule. The "if" clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.
2. C - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope. This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

05 · Conversations

1. An extra mention changes the integration - The lesson's sponsor requests another product mention after the integration plan has been agreed; no extra fee or schedule flexibility is established.
2. A sponsor category conflicts with a segment - Separate fictional case: a fictional podcast sponsor sells sleep products, while a planned comedy segment mocks sleep-tracking gadgets; the approved integration has not yet

been recorded.

3. Choose a makegood that can actually run - Separate fictional case: a sponsor's contracted newsletter mention was omitted. The publisher proposes either a mention in next week's edition or one in a themed edition next month; neither is yet accepted.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | A live mention becomes a recorded clip

A fictional sponsor has agreed to one live webinar mention. The sponsor now requests a separate promotional clip using that mention. Editing effort, talent permissions, and price have not been assessed. Discuss a conditional change proposal.

Role A: You are the sponsorship producer. Explain the additional deliverable and ask which clip use the sponsor needs.

Role B: You are the sponsor's campaign lead. Seek a useful alternative if a separate clip cannot be confirmed yet.

Possible opening: We can assess a separate clip, but it isn't included in the agreed live mention.

Success checks

- Separate the existing mention from the proposed new deliverable.
- Identify scope, permissions, and scheduling checks without giving legal conclusions.
- Agree a conditional proposal rather than an unsupported commitment.

Add a complication: The sponsor asks for a guaranteed delivery date before the review is complete.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

LESSON 08 / FACILITATOR NOTES

Crisis Response and Public Statements

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

CASE

A draft public statement gives an explanation for a production incident while facts are still being verified.

Teach this move

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

Vocabulary to check: public statement, backlash, legal review, holding statement.

Model response

We should state only what has been confirmed, acknowledge the concern, and explain the next information step. The proposed cause is still unverified and needs appropriate review before inclusion.

Listen for, then coach

Ask learners to point to the case fact behind each important statement. Accept different wording when it preserves meaning, fits the listener, and does not invent an outcome. The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Second-round challenge

Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Language-check answers

1. C - The change may have contributed to the delay. 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.
2. B - In this pilot, the observed result was ... This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

05 · Conversations

1. Remove the unverified explanation - A communications lead reviews the lesson's draft public statement about a production incident while facts are still being verified.
2. A circulating clip is not the full recording - Separate fictional case: a shortened rehearsal clip is circulating online; the production team has the full recording but has not yet compared the two versions.

3. A cancelled screening and an unknown cause - Separate fictional case: a screening was cancelled after a projector stopped working; the venue has not established whether the fault was equipment, power, or another cause.

Use the complete ten-turn scripts in the learner workbook and conversation lab. Read with roles, identify the decision or open question, then replay without reading.

06 · Say it: second scenario | An account post nobody recognizes

A fictional studio's social account displayed an unexpected post that has now been removed. The team has not established whether it came from an authorized user, a scheduling error, or unauthorized access. Discuss a holding statement with no premature security diagnosis.

Role A: You are the communications manager. State only the observed post and its removal.

Role B: You are the account operations lead. Explain the unresolved cause and the need for authorized review.

Possible opening: The post has been removed, but we have not established how it was published.

Success checks

- Separate the observed event from possible causes.
- Avoid naming a culprit or confirming unauthorized access without evidence.
- Agree the operational verification and statement review needed before publication.

Add a complication: A senior colleague asks you to announce that the account was hacked.

AI extension: adapt this lesson for your learners and available time.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Writing feedback begins with your draft. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-06. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Adapt a partner or class activity

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Media and Entertainment English

Professional audience: producers, production managers, creative executives, rights coordinators, distribution teams, talent managers, marketing staff, and media operations professionals

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Creative Briefs and Development Notes

Original fictional case: A client asks for a video to feel "premium and energetic." The team has no examples, audience definition, or delivery requirements.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: creative brief: A document defining the audience, objective, message, and requirements for creative work. / tone: The attitude or level of formality conveyed by wording and delivery. / brand fit: How well an activity or message matches a brand's identity and intended audience. / deliverable: A specified item of work to be provided to a customer or project recipient.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Could you share a reference and explain which qualities you want to capture? Let's also confirm the audience and deliverables so the creative direction can be discussed concretely.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Adapt this material for a teaching session

1. Ask me one brief planning question covering learner support needs, group size and available time. Offer a default of two B2 learners and 20 minutes. Stop and wait; use the default only if I choose it.
2. Create a timed plan using the supplied case or dialogue, its actual terminology and one narrow language goal. Include an individual first attempt, partner exchange, focused feedback and a retry. Keep the total within the time I choose. State what the learner should be able to communicate at the end.
3. Provide separate role cards for two or three professional speakers. Each card needs an objective, known information and one question to resolve. Label any invented private information as a variation; do not contradict shared facts. Do not place the model answer on the learner cards.
4. Add a B1 support option with useful frames, a B2 independent task and a C1 extension involving a plausible competing constraint. Maintain the same professional meaning across levels. Explain unfamiliar terms without removing the field's normal language. Include a workable solo alternative.
5. Put teacher notes and suggested responses in a clearly separate section after the learner material. Include likely misunderstandings and a short observation checklist for facts, clarity, tone and next step. Accept multiple successful formulations. Finish with one exit question and a delayed-recall task; identify what the teacher should check before use.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level

Adjust tone and register

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Media and Entertainment English

Professional audience: producers, production managers, creative executives, rights coordinators, distribution teams, talent managers, marketing staff, and media operations professionals

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Creative Briefs and Development Notes

Original fictional case: A client asks for a video to feel "premium and energetic." The team has no examples, audience definition, or delivery requirements.

Language workshop: Ask a precise question

Communication goal: Clarify missing information before responding.

Language guidance: Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): When you say ..., do you mean ...? / Could you clarify which ...? / So, my understanding is Is that right?

Vocabulary: creative brief: A document defining the audience, objective, message, and requirements for creative work. / tone: The attitude or level of formality conveyed by wording and delivery. / brand fit: How well an activity or message matches a brand's identity and intended audience. / deliverable: A specified item of work to be provided to a customer or project recipient.

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Optional second-round challenge: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Could you share a reference and explain which qualities you want to capture? Let's also confirm the audience and deliverables so the creative direction can be discussed concretely.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Match the language to the listener

1. Choose a short message or utterance from the reference and quote it exactly. Identify its purpose and likely audience. Ask me to choose a new audience: a close colleague, a decision-maker, or an external reader who may not know the jargon. Stop and wait.
2. Ask me to adapt that message for the chosen reader, keeping its facts and degree of certainty unchanged. Offer a short frame only if I request help. Wait for my attempt before showing alternatives.
3. Discuss at most three choices in my version: directness, specialist vocabulary and interpersonal tone. Explain when a direct request is clearer than extra politeness, and when an unfamiliar abbreviation needs expansion. Avoid cultural stereotypes or claims that one nationality always communicates a certain way.
4. Show two natural alternatives, such as a concise spoken version and a more explicit written version. Explain the tradeoff in each. Do not turn a request into an order, a possibility into a promise, or a pending decision into approval.
5. Ask me to respond to one realistic follow-up from the new reader, then wait. Finish by asking me to adapt the message for a second audience without losing its core meaning. Give feedback only after the attempt.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level